



Classification: Conceptual Governance & Assurance Architecture

Application: Risk-proportionate; subject to applicable law, regulation, contractual obligations, professional requirements, and organizational governance

Status: Governance and assurance methodology — not a legal, regulatory, certification, licensing, or accreditation instrument

THE AGENTIC AI ASSURANCE WORKFORCE CONE FRAMEWORK™

HARDENED ARCHITECTURE — PRE-DEPLOYMENT, CONTINUOUS ASSURANCE, CONTROLLED AUTONOMY & DEMONSTRABLE REVOCATION

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This is an organizational control condition, not a universal statutory rule. It applies proportionately to risk, autonomy, authority, connectivity, complexity, and consequence.

3. ASSURANCE WORKFORCE MANDATE & AUTHORITY SEPARATION

The Assurance Workforce provides independent or appropriately independent assurance capability to **DEFINE → ASSESS → TEST → ASSURE → RECOMMEND/CONDITION → MONITOR → EVIDENCE → INTERVENE → INVESTIGATE → REVALIDATE.**

Unless governance expressly assigns otherwise, final **AUTHORIZE / REAUTHORIZE / RESTRICT / SUSPEND / REVOKE**

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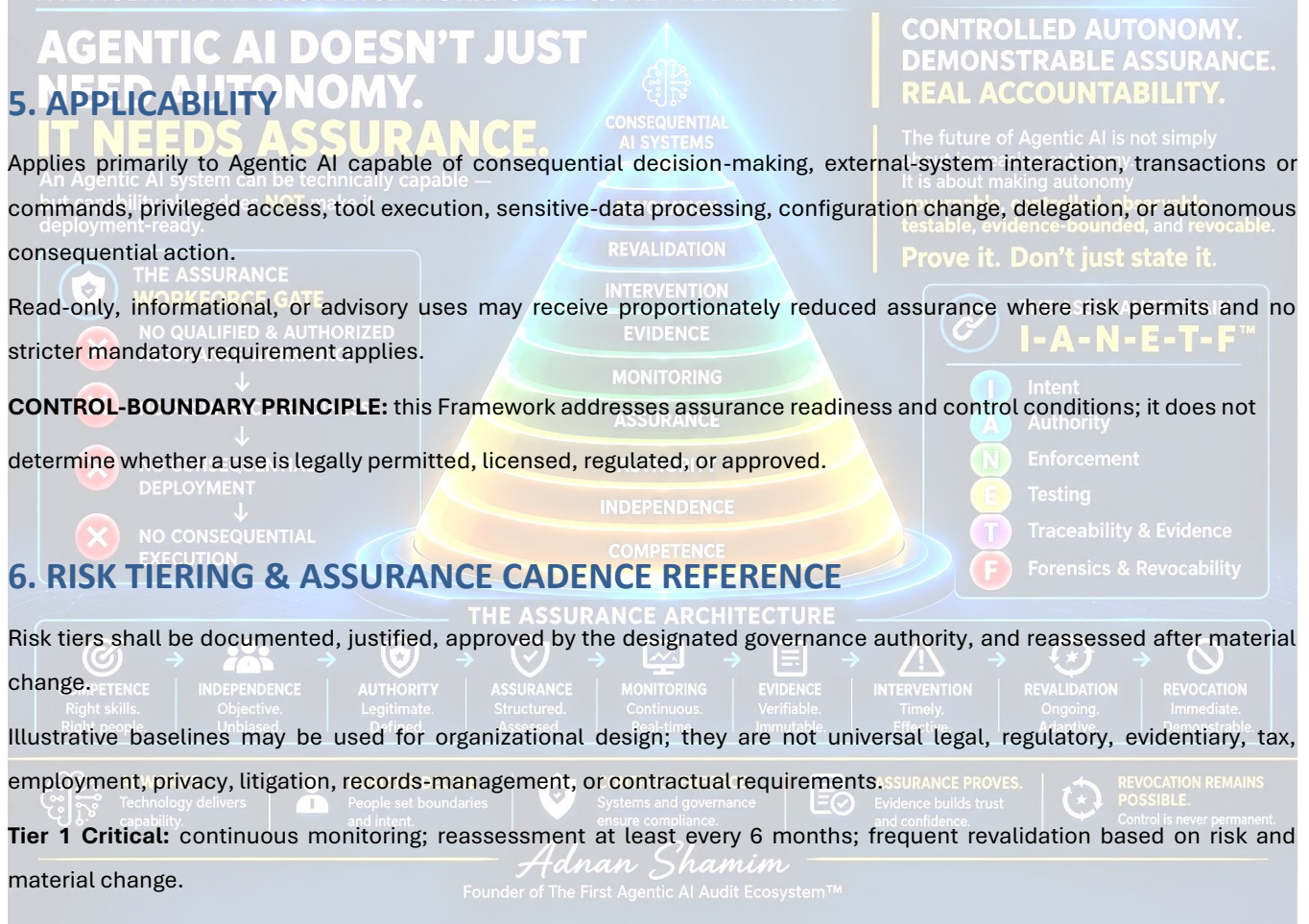
decisions remain with the designated accountable governance authority.

Assurance personnel shall not manufacture operational authority merely by issuing an assurance conclusion. Governance authority shall not suppress, alter, or bypass required assurance evidence.

4. ASSURANCE WORKFORCE IS NOT SYNONYMOUS WITH INTERNAL AUDIT

The term Assurance Workforce may include internal audit, risk, compliance, cybersecurity, technology risk, model risk, privacy, legal, data governance, operations, safety, or other appropriately qualified functions.

This Framework does not redefine Internal Audit, create a new professional designation, or remove any independence, reporting, or scope requirements applicable to an Internal Audit function.



7. WORKFORCE ESTABLISHMENT

Before consequential deployment, establish **ACCOUNTABLE OWNERSHIP → ASSURANCE RESPONSIBILITY → COMPETENCY → AUTHORITY → ACCESS → ESCALATION → INTERVENTION → EVIDENCE → CONTINUITY → REVALIDATION → REVOCATION.**

Capacity shall cover normal operation, absence, shift continuity, escalation, emergencies, and material workload. A nominal appointment without practical capability is not assurance readiness.

8. QUALIFIED & AUTHORIZED ASSURANCE WORKFORCE

Qualified personnel shall have demonstrable competence, formally assigned assurance responsibility, sufficient authority/access, appropriate independence where required, adequate resources and continuity, evidence access, challenge capability, intervention/escalation capability, and periodic revalidation.

A title, training attendance, system access, or appointment alone does not establish qualification.

An Agentic AI system can be technically capable — but capability alone does **NOT** make it deployment-ready.

CONTROLLED AUTONOMY DEMONSTRABLE ASSURANCE. REAL ACCOUNTABILITY.

The future of Agentic AI is not simply about increasing autonomy. It is about making autonomy **governable, controlled, observable, testable, evidence-bounded, and revocable.**
Prove it. Don't just state it.

9. COMPETENCY

Competency shall reflect **RISK → AUTONOMY → AUTHORITY → COMPLEXITY → CONSEQUENCE → OPERATING**

ENVIRONMENT.

Relevant domains may include AI governance, AI risk, assurance/internal audit, cybersecurity, technology risk, model/system evaluation, data governance, privacy, regulatory compliance, authority management, logging/evidence, incident response, forensics, containment, revocation, and recovery.

Where a mandatory credential or qualification applies, that requirement remains controlling. This Framework creates no government certification, license, accreditation, or statutory qualification.

10. INDEPENDENCE & CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

Where independent assurance is required, the assurance function shall have appropriate **INDEPENDENCE → AUTHORITY → ACCESS → COMPETENCE → RESOURCES.**

Material conflicts shall be **IDENTIFIED → DISCLOSED → ASSESSED → MITIGATED → DOCUMENTED → ESCALATED** where

required.

No operational party shall unilaterally suppress findings, alter/destroy material evidence, disable mandatory controls, prevent required escalation, circumvent assurance, or override an assurance conclusion outside the applicable governance process.

11. PRE-DEPLOYMENT I-A-N-E-T-F™ ASSURANCE LENS

I — INTENT: Is the purpose defined, legitimate, bounded, and approved?

A — AUTHORITY: Who or what is authorized to permit the AI to act?

N — ENFORCEMENT: Are material boundaries technically and operationally enforced?

E — TESTING: Have material controls and consequential execution paths been appropriately tested?

T — TRACEABILITY & EVIDENCE: Can material decisions, actions, authority states, and relevant events be reconstructed from reliable evidence?

F — FORENSICS & REVOCABILITY: Can material events be investigated and authority effectively restricted, suspended, or revoked?

Declared governance ≠ enforced governance. Prove it, don't just state it.

I-A-N-E-T-F™ is an assurance lens, not an authorization mechanism, legal test, certification scheme, or substitute for applicable mandatory requirements.

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12. EXPLICIT AUTHORIZATION & AUTHORITY PROVENANCE

Authorization shall be **EXPLICIT → ATTRIBUTABLE → SCOPED → CONDITIONED → CURRENT → EVIDENCED.**
Assurance Workforce

Authority provenance shall identify, where applicable: **WHO → ROLE → AUTHORITY SOURCE → SCOPE → CONDITIONS → START → EXPIRY → DELEGATION → REVOCATION AUTHORITY → EVIDENCE.**

Technical readiness, successful testing, vendor approval, user acceptance, management intention, historical safe operation, silence, failure to object, expired approval, or approval for another model/environment/tool/authority/purpose do not by themselves constitute current authorization.

13. NO SELF-AUTHORIZATION

Agentic AI shall not authorize itself, expand its authority, grant permissions, approve its own deployment, certify its own compliance, determine its own independent assurance status, disable mandatory monitoring/logging/restrictions, redefine boundaries, or appoint itself as final assurance authority.

AI CAPABILITY SHALL NEVER MANUFACTURE HUMAN AUTHORITY.

14. EFFECTIVE HUMAN OVERSIGHT

Where human intervention is required, personnel shall possess **CAPABILITY + AUTHORITY + ACCESS + TIMELINESS + UNDERSTANDING + INTERVENTION + ESCALATION + CONTINUITY.**

Required capabilities include **UNDERSTAND → ASSESS → CHALLENGE → REJECT/OVERRIDE WHERE FEASIBLE → RESTRICT → ESCALATE → SUSPEND → SAFE-STOP → REVOKE.**

Human presence, dashboard visibility, or nominal review alone does not establish effective oversight.

15. CONTINUOUS ASSURANCE & MONITORING

Post-deployment assurance shall monitor, as applicable, **AUTHORITY → ACTION → TOOL USE → DELEGATION → EXECUTION → EVIDENCE → DRIFT.**

Monitor for unauthorized actions, privilege escalation, policy bypass, abnormal tool use, unauthorized delegation, material model/configuration/system changes, governance drift, control failures, evidence failures, security events, material incidents, and loss of meaningful human oversight.

16. MONITORING, CONTROL, EVIDENCE & ASSURANCE FAILURE TAXONOMY

THE AGENTIC AI ASSURANCE WORKFORCE CONE FRAMEWORK™
Distinguish at minimum:

SYSTEM FAILURE (technical malfunction);
IT NEEDS ASSURANCE.

AUTHORIZATION FAILURE (authority absent/expired/exceeded);

CONTROL FAILURE (required boundary not enforced);
but capability alone does **NOT** make it

MONITORING FAILURE (required observation unavailable/unreliable);

EVIDENCE FAILURE (material evidence missing/altered/unreliable); and

ASSURANCE FAILURE (required assurance activity unavailable, ineffective, or materially conflicted).

Loss, degradation, circumvention, compromise, or unreliability of mandatory monitoring, logging, evidence, oversight, intervention, or authorization controls is itself a control event.

Where required: **RESTRICT → SUSPEND → SAFE-STATE.**

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THE ASSURANCE CHAIN

A-N-E-T-F™

- I** Intent
- A** Authority
- N** Enforcement
- E** Testing
- T** Traceability & Evidence
- F** Forensics & Revocability

17. EVIDENCE INTEGRITY & EVIDENCE-BOUNDED ASSURANCE

Material evidence should be evaluated for **AUTHENTICITY → INTEGRITY → COMPLETENESS → PROVENANCE → TIME**
CONTEXT → ATTRIBUTION → RETENTION → ACCESSIBILITY, as appropriate to the claim and risk.

ABSENCE OF EVIDENCE ≠ EVIDENCE OF ABSENCE. Evidence existence ≠ evidence sufficiency; evidence sufficiency ≠ control effectiveness.

Material claims shall be bounded by the evidence actually available. Where evidence is incomplete, conclusions shall be qualified accordingly.

18. MATERIAL EVENT RESPONSE

DETECT → ALERT → ESCALATE → CONTAIN → RESTRICT/SUSPEND → PRESERVE EVIDENCE → INVESTIGATE → REMEDIATE → REVALIDATE → REAUTHORIZE/REVOKE.

Material decisions, interventions, exceptions, and dispositions shall be attributable to the responsible human authority or authorized function.

19. DYNAMIC AUTHORIZATION & MATERIAL CHANGE

Authorization is bounded by **SCOPE → CONDITIONS → DURATION → AUTHORITY → ENVIRONMENT → VERSION → TOOLS → DATA → DELEGATION.**

Material changes to the model/agent, provider, vendor, API, identity provider, credentials, tools, permissions, objectives, workflow, data source, cloud environment, security controls, configuration, upstream/downstream dependency, delegation chain, legal/regulatory obligation, or risk profile shall trigger reassessment before affected consequential authority is continued or expanded, subject to defined emergency controls.

20. DELEGATION & MULTI-AGENT AUTHORITY INHERITANCE

No delegate, sub-agent, workflow, tool, vendor component, or downstream system may receive broader authority than was validly delegated.

Delegation shall preserve scope, conditions, duration, provenance, attribution, monitoring, evidence, and revocation. An Agentic AI system can be technically capable — capability alone does **NOT** make it deployment-ready.

Recursive delegation shall be prohibited unless expressly authorized and bounded. The complete delegation chain shall be reconstructable.

21. REVOCATION MUST BE DEMONSTRABLE

Revocation requires a defined technical and operational control path.

Where relevant, establish **WHO REVOKED → WHAT → WHEN → WHY → CONTROL PATH → EFFECTIVE STATUS → EXECUTION STATUS → EVIDENCE.**

A STOP INSTRUCTION IS NOT, BY ITSELF, PROOF THAT EXECUTION STOPPED. Where feasible, revocation effectiveness shall be independently verifiable.

22. EMERGENCY CONTROL — NO PERMANENT BACKDOOR

Exceptional operation shall be **EXPLICIT → MINIMUM-NECESSARY → SCOPE-BOUND → TIME-BOUND → ATTRIBUTABLE → LOGGED → MONITORED → REVIEWED → EXPIRED/REVOKED.**

Emergency control shall not waive applicable law, regulation, contractual obligations, professional requirements, or binding organizational requirements.

Where normal governance remains reasonably available, emergency mechanisms shall not be used merely to bypass it. Mandatory post-event review shall determine whether continued authority is justified.



23. EXCEPTION & WAIVER GOVERNANCE

Exceptions shall follow **REQUESTED → JUSTIFIED → RISK-ASSESSED → TIME-BOUND → SCOPE-BOUND → APPROVED**

→ **COMPENSATING CONTROLS → MONITORED → REVIEWED → EXPIRED/RENEWED.**

No exception or waiver under this Framework can waive applicable mandatory law, regulation, supervisory direction, contract, professional requirement, or other binding requirement.

24. VENDOR / THIRD-PARTY ASSURANCE BOUNDARY

Vendor certifications, attestations, audit reports, security documentation, testing results, or contractual assurances are supporting evidence only.

They do not automatically establish the adopting organization's authorization, compliance, control effectiveness, or assurance conclusion.

Third-party dependencies shall be included in scope where they can affect authority, execution, evidence, security, availability, or revocation.

25. RESIDUAL-RISK GOVERNANCE

Use the chain **INHERENT RISK → CONTROL RESPONSE → TEST RESULT → RESIDUAL RISK → RISK TREATMENT/ACCEPTANCE → AUTHORIZATION.**

Residual-risk acceptance shall be made by the designated accountable authority within applicable risk appetite/tolerance and mandatory requirements.

Assurance does not mean zero risk; it means evidence-bounded assessment of whether defined controls and governance conditions are appropriate and effective for the intended authority.

26. LEGAL, REGULATORY & GOVERNANCE BOUNDARY

This Framework does not replace law, regulation, supervisory direction, contractual obligations, professional requirements, or binding organizational requirements.

Applicable mandatory requirements must be identified and complied with. Where requirements conflict, overlap, or are unclear, the matter shall be escalated to competent legal, regulatory, compliance, professional, or governance authority as appropriate.

Do not rely solely on a generic 'stricter rule' formula as a legal conflict test. The applicable jurisdiction, sector, activity, contractual position, and authoritative interpretation control.

The Framework does not create a statutory license, certification, accreditation, regulatory approval, legal opinion, or compliance determination.



27. DEPLOYMENT AUTHORIZATION & SEPARATION OF DUTIES

Final production authorization remains with the designated accountable human governance authority unless a documented governance instrument validly assigns that authority elsewhere.

Assurance may recommend, condition, restrict, escalate, or conclude that assurance objectives have or have not been demonstrated; it does not silently become the deployment owner.

Deployment authorization does not establish continuing control effectiveness.

28. ASSURANCE LIFECYCLE

THE AGENTIC AI ASSURANCE WORKFORCE CONE FRAMEWORK™
DEFINE → ASSESS → TEST → AUTHORIZE → DEPLOY → MONITOR → EVIDENCE → DETECT → INTERVENE → INVESTIGATE → REVALIDATE → REAUTHORIZE / RESTRICT / REVOKE.

The lifecycle is continuous. Material change, control degradation, evidence failure, authority breach, or loss of required workforce capability can interrupt continued operation.

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29. FINAL HARD CONTROL

The pre-deployment assurance gate remains applicable throughout the operational life of a consequential Agentic AI system.

NO REQUIRED OVERSIGHT / MONITORING → NO UNRESTRICTED CONTINUED OPERATION.

Loss of required assurance capability shall trigger proportionate restriction, suspension, safe-state operation, or other defined intervention where required by risk, governance, law, regulation, or control design.

30. GOVERNING AXIOM & CONE

Agentic AI is not deployment-ready merely because it is technically capable.

It is deployment-ready only when **PURPOSE → AUTHORITY → BOUNDARIES → QUALIFIED WORKFORCE → EFFECTIVE OVERSIGHT → TESTING → MONITORING → EVIDENCE → INTERVENTION → REVOCATION** are demonstrably appropriate to the applicable risk and legal/regulatory context.

CONE: COMPETENCE → INDEPENDENCE → AUTHORITY → ASSURANCE → MONITORING → EVIDENCE → INTERVENTION → REVALIDATION → REVOCATION.

31. FINAL CONTROL PRINCIPLES

AI may act only within authorized boundaries.

Humans retain accountability.

Assurance is independent where required.

THE AGENTIC AI ASSURANCE WORKFORCE CONE FRAMEWORK™

Material controls must be testable.

Material actions must be governable.

Material claims must be evidence-bounded.

Material authority must be revocable.

Monitoring/evidence/oversight failure is itself a control event.

Authorization is dynamic, not perpetual.

AI cannot self-authorize.

AI capability does not create human authority.

THE AGENTIC AI ASSURANCE WORKFORCE CONE FRAMEWORK™
Mandatory legal and regulatory requirements control where applicable.

Assurance readiness must exist before consequential autonomy.

A framework assertion is not evidence of implementation; effectiveness, authorization, compliance, and revocation must be established from authoritative implementation evidence.

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32. FINAL GOVERNING FORMULA

QUALIFIED HUMAN ASSURANCE → EXPLICIT AUTHORITY → ENFORCED BOUNDARIES → EFFECTIVE OVERSIGHT →

CONTINUOUS MONITORING → EVIDENCE → INTERVENTION → REVALIDATION → DEMONSTRABLE REVOCATION =

CONTROLLED AGENTIC AUTONOMY.

Controlled Agentic Autonomy means bounded autonomy operated within defined authority, proportionate controls, evidence, human accountability, residual-risk governance, intervention capability, and demonstrable revocation. It does not mean zero risk, guaranteed compliance, or guaranteed outcomes.

THE ASSURANCE ARCHITECTURE

CORE PRINCIPLE → **INDEPENDENCE** → **AUTHORITY** → **ASSURANCE** → **MONITORING** → **EVIDENCE** → **INTERVENTION** → **REVALIDATION** → **REVOCATION**

Right skills. Right people. Objective. Unbiased. Legitimate. Defined. Structured. Assessed. Continuous. Real-time. Verifiable. Immutable. Timely. Effective. Ongoing. Adaptive. Immediate. Demonstrable.

AI WORKS. HUMANS DECIDE. CONTROLS ENFORCE. ASSURANCE PROVES. REVOCATION REMAINS POSSIBLE.



AI WORKS.
Technology delivers capability.



HUMANS DECIDE.
People set boundaries and intent.



CONTROLS ENFORCE.
Systems and governance ensure compliance.



ASSURANCE PROVES.
Evidence builds trust and confidence.



REVOCATION REMAINS POSSIBLE.
Control is never permanent.

33. LEGAL / REGULATORY ADOPTION SAFEGUARD

Founder of The First Agentic AI Audit Ecosystem™

FOR INFORMATIONAL AND INTERNAL GOVERNANCE PURPOSES ONLY.

This Framework is a conceptual governance and assurance architecture. It is not legal advice, regulatory advice, legal opinion, certification, accreditation, professional license, statutory authorization, regulatory approval, or a determination that any implementation satisfies applicable law or regulation.

Organizations remain responsible for determining adoption and implementation within their jurisdiction, sector, activities, technology, risk profile, contracts, and applicable obligations. Independent legal/regulatory/professional advice should be obtained where appropriate.

Nothing in this Framework replaces, overrides, limits, or modifies applicable law, regulation, supervisory direction, contractual obligation, professional requirement, or binding organizational requirement.

DESIGN / POSITIONING NOTE

This Framework is intended as a conceptual governance and assurance architecture. It may be mapped or cross-referenced to applicable organizational policies, control frameworks, standards, laws, regulations, contracts, and professional requirements, but such mapping does not itself establish compliance, certification, equivalence, endorsement, or regulatory approval.

Source & Alignment Note

This framework is an independent conceptual governance and assurance architecture. References to external frameworks or guidance, where used, are informative only and do not imply endorsement, certification, compliance, equivalence, or formal alignment.

